

From: Paula Lasersohn motherofpekes@icloud.com
Subject: Special Dispensation
Date: 6 December 2025 at 9:23 am
To: Paula Lasersohn motherofpekes@icloud.com



Subject: Request for Personal Dispensation to Compete Bitless – Pending Full Rule Change (2027)

To: dressage@equestrian.org.au

Cc: (optional – your state dressage chair or technical delegate)

Dear Members of the Equestrian Australia National Dressage Committee (EADC),

I refer to my formal rule-change request of 6 December 2025 (attached / previously sent) in which I asked the Committee to implement the following two welfare reforms from 1 January 2027:

1. Permit approved bitless bridles from Preparatory to Elementary (with later extension).
2. Make rising trot fully optional at all levels with clear penalties for discomfort caused by sitting trot.

While that process runs its course, I respectfully request that the EADC grant me, **Paula Lasersohn – EA Member 1010527**, a **temporary personal dispensation** to compete bitless at official EA dressage events from **1 January 2026 until the date the full rule change comes into effect**.

Details of the requested dispensation:

- Rider: Paula Lasersohn (EA 1010527)
- Horse: [Horse name & Life Number – if registered]
- Bridle type: approved mild bitless design (side-pull or cross-under/LG-type, already illustrated in the proposed Equipment Annex update)
- Levels: Preparatory to Elementary inclusive
- Conditions:
 - Gear check by steward before every test (as normal)
 - Rides to be marked normally until the bridle is noticed, then either:
 - a) hors-concours (non-placing) or
 - b) elimination recorded purely for the bitless bridle (as currently required)
 - All tests to be filmed and made available to the EADC for review

This dispensation would:

- Provide immediate, real-world evidence that bitless dressage at these levels poses no risk to standards or welfare
- Generate valuable Australian data while the Committee finalises the permanent rule change
- Demonstrate leadership and goodwill at a time when dressage's social licence is under intense scrutiny
- Align directly with Section 1.2.1.c of the EA Code of Conduct ("Tack must be designed and fitted to avoid the risk of pain or injury")

Similar temporary dispensations have been granted in the past for therapeutic, para-equestrian, and equipment-trial purposes. I believe this request falls clearly within the same welfare-focused spirit.

I am happy to ride hors-concours only, to cover any additional stewarding costs, and to supply regular reports if required.

Thank you for considering this request. I look forward to your response and remain ready to assist the Committee in any way that helps move Australian dressage forward.

Yours sincerely

Paula Lasersohn

EA Member 1010527

Canberra, ACT

[phone]

[email]

6 December 2025

(Attachment: previous rule-change letter + photo of current bitless bridle fitted to my horse)

Send this as a **second, separate email** right after (or with) the main rule-change letter.

It's polite, practical, and gives them an easy "yes" they can grant immediately while they think about the bigger changes.

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Sent from my iPad